

postpartum core & stability yoga

Here is a gentle postnatal yoga sequence designed to rebuild hip strength, leg stability, and pelvic floor health while reconnecting breath with the deep core with some simple posture activities to add in when needed..

This works well from about 6+ weeks postpartum and can be done in 20–25 minutes.

The focus is on slow, controlled movement, breath, and pelvic floor coordination rather than intensity.

1. Grounding Breath + Pelvic Floor Awareness (3 minutes)

Start lying on your back with knees bent, feet on the floor.

1. One hand on belly, one on ribs.
2. Inhale – allow belly and ribs to expand.
3. Exhale – gently lift pelvic floor and draw lower belly inward.

Repeat 8–10 breaths.

Benefits:

Reconnects breath with pelvic floor

Activates deep core

2. Pelvic Tilts (2 minutes)

From the same position.

1. Inhale – neutral spine.
2. Exhale – tilt pelvis, gently flatten lower back to floor.

3. Engage pelvic floor lightly.

Flow slowly for 10–12 repetitions.

Benefits:

- * Reconnects core
- * Mobilises pelvis
- * Supports diastasis recovery



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3. Glute Bridge Flow (3 minutes)

From constructive rest.

1. Inhale prepare.
 2. Exhale – lift hips slowly.
 3. Engage pelvic floor and glutes.
 4. Inhale hold.
 5. Exhale lower slowly.
- Repeat 10 times.

Optional progression:

- * Hold bridge for 3 breaths.

Benefits:

- * Strengthens glutes
- * Stabilises pelvis
- * Supports pelvic floor

4. Reclined Hip Stability (Dead Bug Arms) (2–3 minutes)

Lift arms to ceiling.

1. Inhale prepare.
 2. Exhale – slowly lower one arm overhead.
 3. Maintain pelvic stability.
 4. Return and switch sides.
- Repeat 8 per side.

Benefits:

- * Deep core stability
- * Pelvic control

5. Tabletop + Bird Dog (4 minutes)

Come onto hands and knees.

1. Inhale neutral spine.
 2. Exhale extend opposite arm and leg.
 3. Engage pelvic floor lightly.
- Hold 2 breaths.
- Repeat 8 each side.

Benefits:

- * Hip stability
- * Core coordination
- * Pelvic floor integration

Add optional chest opener and thread the needle

6. Supported Low Squat Flow (3–4 minutes)

Stand with feet slightly wider than hips.

1. Inhale lower into squat.
 2. Exhale press through heels to stand.
 3. Gently lift pelvic floor as you rise.
- Repeat 10–12 reps.

Optional: hold squat for 3 breaths.

Benefits:

- * Leg strength
- * Functional pelvic floor training
- * Hip opening

7. Low Lunge Hip Stability (3 minutes)

Step one foot forward into a low lunge.

1. Inhale lengthen spine.
2. Exhale gently engage pelvic floor.
3. Slightly shift hips back and forward slowly.

Hold 5 breaths each side.

Benefits:

- * Hip flexor release
- * Pelvic balance
- * Stability through legs

Add optional pigeon pose.

8. Side-Lying Leg Lifts (3 minutes)

Lie on one side.

1. Stack hips.
 2. Lift top leg slowly.
 3. Lower with control.
- Repeat 12 reps each side.

Benefits:

- * Glute medius strength
- * Pelvic stability

Add optional clam shell



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Add optional hydrant and glute donkey kicks.

9. Upper band flow exercises.

Lateral Raises: Slowly raise arms (optional addition of weights) out to your sides. Repeat 8–10 reps.

10. Cactus rotations: Stand or sit tall with core engaged. Raise arms to shoulder height in a 90° cactus/goalpost shape. Rotate forearms back toward the wall behind you until you feel a stretch. Return to the cactus position, squeezing shoulder blades together. Repeat 8–10 reps.

11. Internal/External Rotations: Anchor your arms at elbow height. Keeping your elbow pinned to your side, rotate your forearm outward (away from your body) or inward (toward your stomach). Repeat 8–10 reps.

12. Restorative Pose (3–5 minutes)

Finish in Supported Rest:

- * Lie down
- * Legs elevated on pillow or bolster
- * One hand on belly

Focus on soft pelvic floor relaxation with each inhale

Key Teaching Cues

- * Exhale on effort
- * Engage pelvic floor gently (30–40%)
- * Fully relax pelvic floor between efforts
- * Avoid pushing or bearing down

